15.4 Cad Hardware and Software

Computer hardware and software can be described as follows;

- **Hardware**

  Computer hardware includes types of equipment such as the monitor, hard-drive, keyboard and mouse. Peripherals are added to the hardware to perform specific functions. Examples; Plotters, digitizing tables or printers.

- **Operating Systems**

  An operating system is a vehicle through which the hardware can read the software programmes. These operating systems are used in an organization with software programmes. Certain software programmes can only work on specific operating systems. Examples; Windows, Linux or Mac.

- **Software**

  Software programmes are written to perform different tasks. For example, Microsoft Office is usually used, for writing documents. Other software programmes, such as Corel Draw, are used to create or modify graphics images. Generic software programmes can be used in lot of disciplines. Corel Draw can be applied for design in Graphic Design as well as Fashion Design. For example, Stork is a software programme written exclusively for use in design.

15.4.1 Uses of Computer Aided Design (CAD) in Different Sector

Computer aided design software or CAD software is vastly used in some major sectors of today's technological areas;

- Fashion design sector
- Apparel sector
- AEC i.e. Architecture Engineering and Construction sector
- ECAD i.e. Electronic and electrical sector
- MCAD i.e. Mechanical sector:
  - Aerospace
  - Automotive
  - Machinery
  - Consumer Goods
  - Ship Building

15.4.2 Different areas of Textiles where CAD systems are used

Textile designing is a technical process which includes different methods of textile production. It includes both surface design and structural design of a textile. The textile designer must have knowledge of yarn making, weaving, knitting, dyeing, finishing processes and also knowledge about different types of looms, knitting machines and printing processes.

Following are the types of software developed for various textiles weave design;

- Design Dobby
- Adobe Illustrator
- C-Design Fashion
- Vetigraph
- Corel DRAW

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